CuddleNine

Little Care, Big Love

Complete 0 to 12 Months Baby Care Guide

A practical step-by-step guide for new parents
What to do, what to feed, what to apply — every month explained in detail

First 24 Hours Hour-by-Hour Guide	0–12 Months Feeding Plan
Sleep Schedule Every Month	Skincare & Hygiene Tips
Vaccination Chart	Red Flags & Emergencies
5 Printable Bonus Checklists	Parent Mental Health

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Chapter 1: First 24 Hours — Hour-by-Hour Guide

The most critical time for new parents. This guide tells you exactly what to do, what to apply, and what to feed right after delivery.

Hours 0–2 (Immediately After Delivery)

What happens:

- Baby is placed on mother's chest (skin-to-skin) — this is the most important first step
- Nurse cleans the baby gently
- First feed (colostrum) — breastfeeding should start within the first hour

What to apply:

- Nothing! Newborn skin should stay plain — no powder, oil, or lotion
- Only gently wipe with a soft cotton cloth

What to feed:

- Only mother's first milk (colostrum) — yellowish, thin, and extremely powerful
- Formula only if doctor specifically advises

Hours 2–6

What happens:

- Baby's first diaper — first stool is "meconium" (black-green) — this is completely normal
- Nurse measures baby — weight, length, head circumference
- Mother needs rest

What to apply:

- Umbilical cord stump — keep dry, no oil or powder
- Fold diaper below the stump so it stays dry

What to feed:

- Feed every 2 hours — even if baby is sleeping
- Wake the baby for feeds in the first 24 hours (very important)

Hours 6–12

What happens:

- Baby's first urine — should happen within 24 hours
- Body temperature can drop — put on cap + mittens + socks
- Baby sleeps a lot — this is normal

What to apply:

- Cotton nappies or diapers — change every 2–3 hours
- Avoid wet wipes — use only cotton + lukewarm water for the first 15–20 days

What to feed:

- Only breast milk — no water (do not give water before 6 months)
- Formula babies: sterilized bottle, room-temperature milk

Hours 12–24

What happens:

- Baby may look a little yellow — this can be physiological jaundice — get it checked by doctor
- No full bath yet — only sponge bath until the cord falls off
- Mother's milk starts coming in — breasts may feel hard — warm compress helps

What to apply:

- For sponge bath: lukewarm water + soft cotton towel
- Nothing on the umbilical stump — keep it dry and clean
- Avoid baby lotion/oil in the first 24 hours (skin is very sensitive)

What to feed:

- 8–12 feeds are normal — feed on demand
- Formula: 30–60 ml every 3 hours (as per doctor's advice)

RED FLAGS — Call Doctor Immediately:

- Baby is struggling to breathe or making unusual breathing sounds
- Body temperature below 97°F or above 99.5°F
- Baby has not fed for 4+ hours
- No urine within 24 hours
- Skin or lips turning blue

Summary Table — First 24 Hours

Time	What to Do	What NOT to Do
0–2 hrs	Skin-to-skin + first feed	Apply powder or oil
2–6 hrs	Keep cord dry, feed every 2 hrs	Touch the stump with diaper
6–12 hrs	Cap + mittens, wipe with cotton	Use wet wipes
12–24 hrs	Sponge bath, check jaundice	Full bath or give water

Chapter 2: Month 1 (0–30 Days) — The Adjustment Month

Feeding (What to Feed):

- Only breast milk or formula — nothing else
- Feed every 2–3 hours — 8–12 times a day
- No water, honey, or glucose water (honey can be dangerous for infants)

What to Apply:

- Umbilical stump: Keep dry, apply nothing — it usually falls off in 7–15 days
- Skin: For first 2–3 weeks, only cotton + water — avoid soap
- Diaper area: Wipe with cotton cloth; use thin layer of zinc oxide cream if rash appears
- Massage: Start after 2–3 weeks — sesame or coconut oil (do a patch test first)

Sleep: 16–18 hours — but wake every 2 hours for feeds

Milestones: Eyes begin to focus, reacts to sound, slight neck control

Activity: Increase skin-to-skin contact, sing soft lullabies

Note: Check for jaundice (yellow skin/eyes) — see doctor if it lasts more than 24 hours

Chapter 3: Month 2 — The Smile Month

Feeding (What to Feed):

- Only milk — feeding pattern starts settling (every 3 hours)
- Mother's diet affects milk taste — avoid heavy onion and garlic if possible

What to Apply:

- Start gentle baby soap (alternate days, e.g., Wednesday & Saturday)
- Cradle cap (flaky scalp): Apply coconut oil for 15 minutes, then gently brush
- Keep nails trimmed (babies scratch themselves)

Sleep: 15–16 hours — night feeds still needed

Milestones: Social smile appears! Cooing sounds (goo-goo)

Activity: Start tummy time 2–3 minutes daily — strengthens neck

Note: Excessive crying or feeding refusal — consult doctor

Chapter 4: Month 3 — The Communication Month

Feeding (What to Feed):

- Only milk — intervals stretch to 3–4 hours
- Formula babies may take 90–120 ml per feed

What to Apply:

- Daily massage around 3–4 pm (daytime) — gentle exercises for tummy, arms, legs
- Face cream only if skin is dry — use fragrance-free baby lotion

Sleep: 14–16 hours — some babies sleep 5–6 hours at night

Milestones: Opens and closes hands, turns toward rattle sounds, first laughter!

Activity: Show colorful toys 20–30 cm away (eye-tracking practice)

Note: Poor head control or crossed eyes — get checked

Chapter 5: Month 4 — The Rolling Month

Feeding (What to Feed):

- Only milk — baby may get distracted while feeding (looks around) — feed in a quiet room

What to Apply:

- Teething may start (extra drooling, putting things in mouth) — offer sterilized silicone teether
- Trim nails every week with a baby nail clipper

Sleep: 14–15 hours — sleep regression is common (night waking) — usually settles in 2–3 weeks

Milestones: Rolls over! (tummy to back / back to tummy) — never leave baby alone on bed

Activity: Increase tummy time to 10 minutes, copy “ah-oo” sounds

Note: After rolling starts, constant supervision is essential — begin baby-proofing

Chapter 6: Month 5 — The Grasping Month

Feeding (What to Feed):

- Only milk — schedule becomes more regular
- Iron stores start depleting — ask doctor about iron drops

What to Apply:

- No teething gel without doctor's advice — teether + gentle gum massage is enough
- Hair oil maximum twice a week (too much causes dandruff)

Sleep: 14 hours — 2–3 naps during the day

Milestones: Grasps objects, brings feet to mouth, stranger anxiety may begin

Activity: Give rattles, practice high-fives and hand clapping

Note: Weight not increasing or excessive crying — consult doctor

Chapter 7: Month 6 — Solids Begin!

Feeding (What to Feed):

- First solid: lentil water or rice cereal — 1–2 spoons in the morning after milk
- 3-day rule: Introduce one new food for 3 days to check for allergy
- Safe foods: Moong dal water, mashed banana, apple puree, carrot puree, rice
- Avoid: Honey (dangerous), cow's milk (not yet), salt, sugar, whole dry fruits, citrus

What to Apply:

- If teeth are coming: Use finger brush with water only
- Wipe face frequently during meals — leftover food can irritate skin

Sleep: 14 hours — 2 naps

Milestones: Sits with support, turns when name is called, babbling ("ba-ba", "da-da")

Activity: Supported sitting practice, introduce new tastes slowly

Note: 6-month vaccination + iron/calcium drops — doctor visit is important

Chapter 8: Month 7 — Real Taste of Food

Feeding (What to Feed):

- Now 2 meals + milk
- Khichdi (mashed dal-rice), banana, apple, semolina porridge (no sugar)
- Egg yolk can be introduced (if not vegetarian) — follow 3-day rule
- Water: 50–100 ml per day (start offering from a cup)

What to Apply:

- Brush teeth daily with finger brush and water
- Nail care once a week

Sleep: 13–14 hours — 2 naps

Milestones: Sits without support, transfers objects from one hand to another, “mama-papa” type sounds

Activity: Pull toys on string, practice clapping

Chapter 9: Month 8 — The Crawling Month

Feeding (What to Feed):

- 2–3 meals + milk — introduce finger foods: steamed carrot sticks, banana pieces (self-feeding practice)
- Wheat porridge, dalia, curd (excellent probiotic for digestion)

What to Apply:

- Sunscreen! Baby goes outside now — SPF 30+ baby sunscreen (avoid 10 am–4 pm peak sun)
- Mosquito protection — prefer net or full sleeves over chemical repellents

Sleep: 13–14 hours — naps may reduce from 2 to 1

Milestones: Crawling begins! Baby-proof the house: socket covers, clear floor, soft corners on tables

Activity: Play “Where is the ball?”, name objects, stacking cups

Chapter 10: Month 9 — Getting Ready to Stand

Feeding (What to Feed):

- 3 meals + milk (family food without chili/salt, served separately)
- Soft roti pieces can be offered
- Crumbled paneer for protein

What to Apply:

- Toothbrushing twice daily — rice-grain size fluoride toothpaste (ask doctor first)
- Hair wash twice a week

Sleep: 13–14 hours — 1–2 naps

Milestones: Tries to stand holding furniture, waves bye-bye, object permanence (looks for hidden toys — play peekaboo!)

Activity: Avoid baby walkers (can affect posture) — allow standing with furniture or push walker

Chapter 11: Month 10 — The Steps Month

Feeding (What to Feed):

- 3 meals + 1 snack + milk
- Almost everything cooked at home — light turmeric and cumin is okay
- Still avoid cow's milk — continue breast milk/formula until 1 year

What to Apply:

- Brush after night feed (milk sugar can cause tooth decay)
- Check for cavities: black spots on teeth see pediatric dentist

Sleep: 12–14 hours — one nap starts settling

Milestones: Cruising! (walking sideways holding furniture), first real words ("mama" or "papa" with meaning)

Activity: Throw ball, show flowers, name objects ("this is a cup")

Chapter 12: Month 11 — Walking Practice

Feeding (What to Feed):

- 3 meals + 2 snacks + milk
- Full egg can be introduced if not already started
- Still avoid: whole dry fruits (choking risk — powder them), popcorn, chips, honey, juice

What to Apply:

- 4–8 teeth may be present — brushing twice a day is non-negotiable
- Trim toenails too — baby is more mobile now

Sleep: 12–13 hours — 1 nap (2–3 hours in the afternoon)

Milestones: Walks with one-hand support, sits and stands independently, plays with utensils (throwing food is normal — ignore it)

Activity: Simple instructions (“Give me the ball”), stacking rings

Chapter 13: Month 12 — Happy Birthday! The Walking Month

Feeding (What to Feed):

- Cow's milk can be introduced (as per doctor) — max 300–400 ml/day (too much milk reduces appetite and iron)
- 3 meals + 2 snacks — seat baby at the family table — eating habits form now
- Birthday cake/chocolate — just a few spoons for taste — don't start sugar habit

What to Apply:

- Brush twice daily with rice-grain fluoride toothpaste
- Sunscreen every time baby goes outside
- Full daily bath is now fine

Sleep: 12–13 hours — 10–11 hours solid night sleep + 1 nap

Milestones: Walking! (some walk at 9 months, late walking till 15–16 months is normal), says 2–3 words, tries spoon (messy is okay!)

Activity: Dance to rhymes, throw and catch ball, look at picture books

Chapter 14: Vaccination Chart

This chart is based on the standard immunization schedule. Always confirm with your pediatrician as some vaccines may vary by country or be available privately.

Age	Vaccine	Notes
At Birth	BCG, Hepatitis B (Birth dose), OPV-0	Usually given in hospital
6 Weeks	DTwP/DTaP-1, IPV-1, Hep B-2, Hib-1, Rotavirus-1, PCV-1	First major shots
10 Weeks	DTwP/DTaP-2, IPV-2, Hib-2, Rotavirus-2, PCV-2	
14 Weeks	DTwP/DTaP-3, IPV-3, Hib-3, Rotavirus-3, PCV-3	
6 Months	Influenza-1 (optional), Hep B-3	
7 Months	Influenza-2 (optional)	
9 Months	MMR-1, Typhoid Conjugate	
12 Months	Hepatitis A-1	

Parent Tip:

- On vaccination day, ensure baby is well-rested and has eaten lightly
- Mild fever after shots is common — use paracetamol syrup only as advised by doctor
- A cool cloth on the injection site can provide comfort

Chapter 15: Red Flags — When to See a Doctor

If you notice any of these signs, contact your pediatrician or go to the nearest hospital immediately. Do not wait.

Breathing Difficulty: Fast breathing, wheezing, chest retractions, blue lips

High Fever: Temperature 100.4°F (38°C) or higher in a baby under 3 months

Feeding Refusal: Not eating or drinking for 8–12 hours

Forceful Vomiting: Green or bloody vomit, or projectile vomiting after every feed

Dehydration: Dry lips, sunken eyes, no urine for 6+ hours, sunken fontanelle

Seizures: Body jerks, eyes rolling up, loss of consciousness

Worsening Jaundice: Yellow color spreading, baby becoming lethargic

Umbilical Infection: Pus, redness, foul smell, or fever with cord issues

Inconsolable Crying: Crying continuously for 3+ hours, hard abdomen

Head Injury / Fall: Vomiting, drowsiness, or change in eyes after a fall

Keep These Numbers Handy:

- Ambulance: 108 / 102 (India) or your local emergency number
- Save your pediatrician + nearest hospital number
- Poison Control (India): 1800-116-117

Chapter 16: Bonus Checklists (Printable)

Print these checklists and keep them handy. Daily tracking becomes much easier.

1 Feeding Tracker (One Day)

Time	Type (Breast/Formula)	Amount / Duration	Notes
___ : ___	Breast Formula	_____	
___ : ___	Breast Formula	_____	
___ : ___	Breast Formula	_____	
___ : ___	Breast Formula	_____	
___ : ___	Breast Formula	_____	
___ : ___	Breast Formula	_____	

2 Newborn Shopping Checklist

Clothes (bodysuits, sleepsuits, caps, mittens, socks) — 6–8 sets
Diapers (newborn size) + wet wipes (or cotton)
Baby blankets / swaddles — 2–3
Digital thermometer
Nail clipper / file
Baby bathtub or sponge bath set
Mild baby soap + shampoo
Zinc oxide cream (for diaper rash)
Coconut / sesame oil (for massage)
Car seat (age-appropriate)
Stroller / carrier
Bottles + sterilizer (if using formula)

3 Sleep Log (One Week)

Day	Night Sleep	Nap 1	Nap 2	Total
Mon	___ hrs	___	___	___
Tue	___ hrs	___	___	___
Wed	___ hrs	___	___	___
Thu	___ hrs	___	___	___
Fri	___ hrs	___	___	___
Sat	___ hrs	___	___	___
Sun	___ hrs	___	___	___

4 Vaccination Reminder

- Birth: BCG, Hep B, OPV-0 — Date: _____
- 6 Weeks: _____
- 10 Weeks: _____
- 14 Weeks: _____
- 6 Months: _____
- 9 Months: _____
- 12 Months: _____

5 Emergency Contact Card

- Pediatrician: _____ Phone: _____
- Nearest Hospital: _____ Phone: _____
- Ambulance: 108 / Local Emergency Number
- Parent Alternate Number: _____
- Family Emergency Contact: _____
- Baby's Blood Group: _____ Allergies: _____

3 Things to Remember Every Month

1. Follow the vaccination chart — never skip doses
2. Weight check: If weight is not increasing monthly, see the doctor
3. 3-day rule: Introduce every new food for 3 days — stop if allergy signs (rash, vomiting, loose stools) appear

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With CuddleNine

Little Care, Big Love

May your baby's first year be safe, happy, and full of love.
This guide is just a starting point — every baby is unique. Always follow your doctor's advice.

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